

Chang further added that he "...does not mind if people choose other [Linux] distributions." Interestingly, Asus opted for Ubuntu 10.10 for its notebooks although Ubuntu 11.04 came out back in April. The company is planning to launch 'many more' Eee PC models running Ubuntu later this year. For now, it remains to be seen if the trio of Atom notebooks becomes successful in winning the war with Windows.

HTC to officially unlock Android bootloader

Smartphone manufacturer HTC recently announced that it would no longer be locking bootloaders on its handsets, making it easier for users to unlock future HTC phones and, hopefully, tablets. The announcement came after an online petition to unlock the bootloaders and disable the NAND protection on HTC phones garnered over 7,000 votes.

In a post on social networking site Facebook, Peter Chou, chief executive officer, HTC, said, "There has been overwhelmingly customer feedback that people want access to open bootloaders on HTC phones. I want you to know that we've listened. Today, I'm confirming we will no longer be locking the bootloaders on our devices."

The Taiwan-based company has not yet confirmed exactly when the new bootloader policy will go into effect and if existing phones will receive updates to unlock the bootloaders.

openSUSE renames OBS

The openSUSE Build Service will now be renamed the Open Build Service, retaining the well-known OBS acronym. According to Jos Poortvliet, the openSUSE community manager, the move is "...a small but important step in the right direction for us," adding that the idea for the name change came from community members as OBS works for more than just openSUSE.

The openSUSE Build Service started out as an internal SUSE technology. In 2006, it was decided to open its source code and development process. From that point on, the scope of the openSUSE Build Service started to widen. First, it was just to build add-on packages for SUSE Linux. Later on, it was able to build openSUSE itself and to also support non-SUSE distributions (Fedora, Ubuntu, MeeGo and others) and packaging systems (RPM, Debian, Kiwi, etc), now expanded to 21 build targets on six architectures.

"We will support even more systems in future, non-Linux targets and also more specialised Linux targets like maintenance channels. But while 'OBS' is meant for a much wider audience than openSUSE, being used by projects and companies like VLC, MeeGo, Dell and many others, its name misleadingly signaled a distribution-specific purpose," explained Poortvliet.

The branding of OBS will be adapted to make it easy for those deploying their own OBS projects to name it appropriately, while staying connected with the main OBS project. "We suggest naming a project-specific OBS instance 'XXX Open Build Service', like 'VLC Open Build Service'," Poortvliet said.



"We're not planning Chrome OS for tablets."



Google will continue to keep its focus on notebooks, and has no plans to make Chrome OS available on tablets or to merge it with its popular Android

software for smartphones. The operating system is a Web browser that steers users to applications such as e-mail and spreadsheets directly on the Web, instead of using software stored on PCs.

"Chrome OS is a computer model designed with various form factors in mind, but we are entirely focused on the notebook form factor for now. We have no other plans at this time," said Sundar Pichai, senior vice president for Google's Chrome.

Skype terminating contract with Digma

Skype has announced its decision not to renew its agreement with the open source SIP software developer Digma that allowed it to offer its customers Skype for Asterisk. A letter circulated to Digma channel partners explained that the Asterisk add-on was developed with the assistance of Skype and contained components which were owned by Skype. The letter also mentioned: "Skype for Asterisk sales and activations will cease on July 26, 2011."

Mark Amick, director of product management, Digma confirmed the content of the letter saying it was "extremely disappointed by Skype's decision to terminate the contract which allows for Skype for Asterisk; we understand that they have changing business models". However, Skype will continue to support existing users (and those that purchase and activate before July 26) until 2013.